

Types of sentence by structure

YPES OF SENTENCE ACCORDING TO STRUCTURE*

This is the classification of sentences according to their grammatical structures.

SIMPLE SENTENCE:

This is a kind of sentence with one main verb. It consists of one subject and one predicate and makes a single thought. It may possess auxiliary verbs but has only one main verb.

Study these:

She travelled to Akure.

I was left with no one at home.

The captain of the team elected by the coaching crew scored a goal at the last match.

The above sentences have one main verb each, which are underlined respectively.

COMPOUND SENTENCE:

This is a kind of sentence that is made up of two simple sentence joined with a coordinating conjunction – and, but, yet, or, etc. It possesses two subjects and two predicates joining the two thoughts.

Study these:

a. John likes mangoes.

b. Mark likes oranges.

Sentences (a) and (b) are simple sentences but can be joined with a coordinating conjunction.

John likes mangoes but Mark likes oranges

More examples:

a. They told him but he did not believe.

b. She saw her mother and her brother arrive.

When the subjects are the same, the second subject is usually omitted but when they differ, they are both written.

c. The boy came home.

d. The boy washed his clothes



Joining them to form a compound sentence, it will be written thus:

The boy came home and washed his clothes.

3. COMPLEX SENTENCE:

It is a kind of sentence with one simple sentence and one or more subordinate clause joined with a subordinating conjunction – when, after, while, where, immediately, because, etc.

Study these:

a. I met the girl when she was crying

b. He was dismissed because of his fraudulent acts.

c. After he arrived, Bode came to see me because he needed some money.

The underline words are the main or simple sentences, while the ones not underlined are the subordinate clauses.

4. *COMPOUND COMPLEX SENTENCE:*

This is a kind of sentence with two or more simple sentences and one or more subordinate clauses. It has more than one simple sentence with one or more than one subordinate clause.

Study these:

a. The boy is fluent and brilliant because he attends a private school.

b. The boy came to then stream and washed his clothes because it was dirty.

c. The man shot at the bird, he fried it but he was unable to eat it because he felt sick after he left the farm.

Note that a simple sentence differs not from a main clause.

